

END THE END CONCLUSION THE READING BERESHIT THE TEXT THE CORPUS THE 299
THE SKY THE FIELD EVIDENCE

START ↗

II · PROCEDURE

How the Voynich Manuscript is to be read

Stated so it can be followed or broken: direction, scale, anchor, what the text is, what the marks are, and what is still open.

Wallet: `bc1qd8wcrsmkk0ghegf5t2jsezg2ve7rtx6vvc79lx`

1

Direction

Open the Voynich Manuscript at its last page and read toward the first. Within each line, read right to left.

- The starred quire runs f116v, then f116r back to f103r. The rest of the book follows in the same backward order: the container pages, herbal, rosettes, bathing, zodiac, astronomical, herbal, f1r.
- Within a line, take the glyphs from the right end. Letter sums do not depend on order, so a cell is the same either way; the positional part — the ϕ coordinate — does change, and it is the ϕ part that carries the reading.
- Lines within an entry run top to bottom. This is the one part not settled: read bottom to top as well and entry 6 gives 192 instead of 203.

Why. The zodiac quire in binding order runs the Sun's year forward, Pisces to Sagittarius. Read back to front it runs the order of the ages, ending on Pisces — where the equinox stood in 1420. Precession runs against the year, so a record of precession runs against the book.

2

Scale

A figure is a degree of the Sun's path. Twelve signs of thirty figures is 360 — one whole turn.

SIGN	FIGURES DRAWN	AS PRECESSION	AS A YEAR
Pisces	29	74.1 yr	29 days
Aries	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Taurus	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Gemini	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Cancer	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Leo	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Virgo	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Libra	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Scorpio	30	71.6 yr	30 days
Sagittarius	30	71.6 yr	30 days

Pisces holds 29, not 30 — the transcribers' note says the outer ring has "19 (NOT 20)", and the count from the full-size image confirms it. Gemini's thirtieth figure is drawn but carries no label. Capricorn and Aquarius are lost with folio 74.

Read at either scale the drawing holds: one figure is a day of the year, or 71.6 years of precession, and one sign is one dlog ray of GF(257).

3

Anchor

The book dates itself. Do not bring a date to it.

1408

the five starless figures put the
new Moon on Gemini 13

1427

the same, within 2°, one Metonic
cycle later

7 of 19

fio3r's red stars, on the cycle's
seven long years

6,939

27×257 days — against 6,939.75
in nineteen years

Prague, 50.1° N, in the frame of date: obliquity 23.5146°, the longest day 10φ hours exactly, the sunrise point swinging 51.54° to 128.46°. Both tests are worked on [The Sky](#).

4

What the text is

The text of a passage is the path of the Sun for that passage.

Measured, not assumed. Over the ten surviving signs:

+0.645

mean label length vs the length of
the day at Prague

−0.858

mean letter value vs the same

13.50 +

7.32 · i

hours of day from the lettering
index

Long-day signs carry more a i r n m l h c; short-day signs more e d y k o. A longer word is a longer course of the Sun, and the lettering itself is the measure. The lost Capricorn would run 5.21 letters to a label and Aquarius 5.58.

```
source artifacts/voynich_2026-09-19/stars/zodiac_lettering.txt,  
sun_meter.txt
```

5

What the marks are

Of 299 figures, 294 hold a star. The marks that break the pattern are the data — the full table is on [The 299](#).

- **Five hold no star.** Gemini 13, Cancer 10, Cancer 18, Virgo 22, Sagittarius 18
 - **Four are crowned.** Cancer 27, Leo 24, Libra 7, Scorpio 14
 - **Stars on a string fall away** across the book, and so do barrels and clothing.
 - Eclipses Prague could see land on figures whose star is marked and no other.
-

6

What any answer must satisfy

A proposed decipherment of the Voynich Manuscript has to clear what is already measured. These are on [Evidence](#) with their sources; in short:

- Letter entropy 2.12–2.35 bits, against 3.04–3.60 for ten candidate languages.
 - 2.7 to 4.4 standard deviations from every one of those languages, when they sit 0.6 to 2.7 from each other.
 - No a followed by u anywhere, against 4,279 a followed by two strokes.
 - Stroke runs closed by the hook stop at four, like a scribe's j, ij, iij, iiij.
 - And it must fail where the field failed: no additive glyph values make the entries equal the verses of Genesis.
-

7

What is still open

1. Whether lines inside an entry run down only (203) or up as well (192).
2. Whether the rings of a zodiac page are read outward, inward, or by the clock. Every result here takes the transcribers' list order and has not been tested against another.
3. Why three of the five starless figures do not fall on a new Moon.
4. The two lost signs — folio 74 carried Capricorn and Aquarius, so mid-December to early February has no figure.
5. The centre words — mars, aberil, may, yony, iollet, augst, octebre, novebre — are month names in a Romance hand. Whose hand, and whether they were added later, is not settled here.

Built 2026-09-21 from the corpus and ~/Documents/artifacts. Every figure on this site is read from a file at build time by build.py; none is typed in.

Emerald tablet: 1,460 words over 257 cells · field GF(257), $g = 3$ · the derivation this answers is at [start.rito.one](#).

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